

what worked in Indonesia's favour, making it the fourth largest economy. A lot of the world's assembling and a lot of technology recycling happens here which enables it to be competitive on prices, second only to Nigeria.

Brazil: once considered a failed state because it was always promising and never delivering, Brazil finally delivered. When China went missing, it stepped up to the plate and filled the void in not only mining, but also food production and manufacturing. The first successes saw a drastic change in the lifestyle of people, and what used to be slums at one time are now a bustling modern city that rivals New York and London. A strict clampdown on the drug and criminal cartel along with a visionary leader in the form of ex football great Ronaldinho taking the reigns in 2030 led to a meteoric rise of Brazil.

Mexico: Mexico is another Brazil like story, and they managed to use



The BSE building in the background of Rhythm House

specialised crops and set up factories making the world's sneakers and apparel. A government stimulus offering Mexicans a free holiday in Japan for every second child, really kickstarted the population growth again. Never underestimate the power of Jollywood!

Japan: While Japan was the first to stagnate and start on a negative population growth cycle that seemed impossible to stop, it did what no one would have ever imagined possible, and opened up its borders to skilled migration, and in a short span of 10 years went from being a super traditional insular culture to one that welcomed young engineers from across the globe and celebrated their

In the past 18 years, Lagos has transformed. In terms of roads, in terms of infrastructure, in terms of governance, in terms of a general investment environment, in terms of security, the government has given people a greater opportunity to thrive.

—Lamido Sanusi, Emir of Kano

<https://dgit.in/lagosrising>

culture. This helped Japan stave off certain doom and start rising on this list again. It's also now considered the cultural potpourri of the world and leads the world in entertainment and cinema.

Russia: Another former great that refused to change and stayed insular like the US and South Korea, Russia grows gradually because of a small population growth and an ever increasing ability to cultivate more land as the earth warms. Although it was plagued with diseases and new infections due to the melting of the permafrost, it makes up for it by growing crops for 8 months of the year. A discovery of a huge vein of rare earth elements and oil in the Siberian traps ensures that Russia has the ability to decide its own fate and continue growing slowly over time.

Nigeria: The fastest growing African nation, Nigeria has a population of eager young people who are willing to work hard and play harder. Thanks to electing a young, secular president in 2032, Nigeria was finally able to end its religious infighting and rampant corruption, and focus on the path of growth that its previous president had started it on in 2020. A dedicated

focus on setting up large scale assembly units for phones helped – about 45% of all phones bear an Assembled in Nigeria stamp on them.

South Korea: While the China strike really did help South Korea climb the GDP ladder, it's since started to slip one place every three years on average. This is because it has witnessed the largest fall in working age people over the last 12 years from 2038 onwards. A slow birth rate that equals the death rate means a lack of growth in population, like most small countries across the globe, but it especially harmed South Korea, which stayed insular instead of welcoming multiculturalism like other small countries did.

In 2020 it was predicted that the GDP of the world would be triple the 2020 figure by 2050. This was an ambitious projection that never came to pass, but the current figure stands just below 240% growth from 2050, and the world is looking poised to beat the 3X of 2020 mark by 2060. Growth has slowed to a 1.8% global average, but this is still remarkable considering the horrible year that 2020 was. First the SARS-nCoV2

virus decimated the world's economy, and then China shut out the world... it was no wonder that people thought a doomsday was approaching – with the Mayans becoming relevant again, and wild theories about aliens and other things circulating. We just wish we could go back and tell the world in 2020 to keep their chins up. Anything is possible if humanity is willing to work together. 

Suggested Reading

- UK Govt. Report on AI patents: dgit.in/patentai
- PWC World Report: dgit.in/pwcwr
- Can tech survive without China? dgit.in/twc
- Misleading trade deficit: dgit.in/tdmisleading
- 5G wars: dgit.in/5gswars
- Manipulation of Yuan: dgit.in/cnyuan
- Difficult to manufacture in India?: dgit.in/mii
- All sorts of country data: ourworldindata.org
- World ewaste data: dgit.in/ewastemon
- Rare earth elements: dgit.in/geologyree